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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

FIRST SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024

First Semester

Discipline Specific Core Course - MG1DSCAVE100

HISTORY OF ANIMATED FILMMAKING AND VFX

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Part A

Short Answer Questions

Answer any 5 out of 7 questions Each question carries 2 marks

1. International Animation Day (IAD) is celebrated on October 28**.**
   It was established in 2002 by the Association Internationale du Film d'Animation (ASIFA) to commemorate the first public performance of Émile Reynaud's Théâtre Optique in 1892. This event was held at the Musée Grévin in Paris.

2. The invention of the **rotoscope** by Max Fleischer-Max Fleischer was a Polish - American animator, inventor, film director and producer.The rotoscope allowed animators to trace over live-action footage frame by frame, translating natural human and animal movements directly into animated characters. Max Fleischer used rotoscoping in a number of his cartoons. The animation of Gulliver in "Gulliver's Travels" (1939) is a good example.
3. Motion Capture- is the process of recording the movement of objects or people and using that information to animate digital character models in 2D or 3D computer animation. "Sinbad: Beyond The Veil of Mists" is the first feature length computer animation film created by Pentamedia, India using motion-capture.
4. Plane Crazy is a silent animated short film produced by Walt Disney and Ub Iwerks**,** first created in 1928**.** It is notable for being one of the earliest appearances of Mickey Mouse**,** alongside Minnie Mouse**.** Plane Crazy Plot- Mickey Mouse dreams of becoming an aviator like Charles Lindbergh. He builds a makeshift airplane and invites Minnie Mouse for a ride. The film is filled with slapstick comedy as Mickey's

antics create chaos in his attempt to fly, showcasing his mischievous and daring personality.

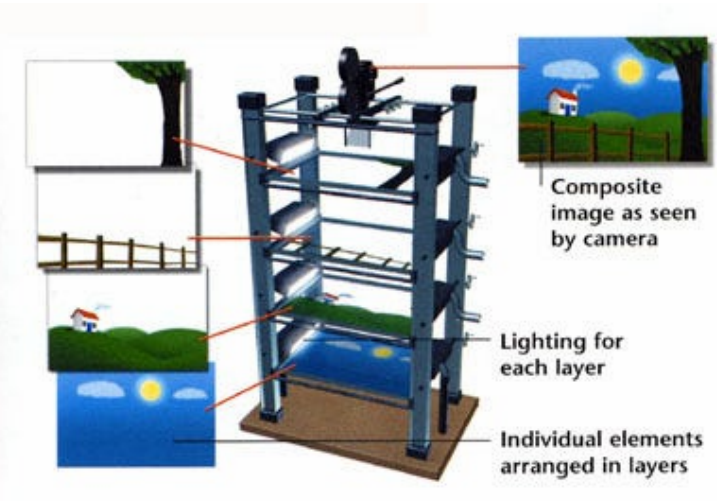
5. Modern Animated Film of choice
6. The purpose of using miniatures in film special effects is to create realistic representations of large-scale objects that would be impractical, expensive or dangerous to construct or film in real life. Example-Star Wars: Miniatures were used extensively for the Death Star, spaceships and iconic battle sequences.
7. Osamu Tezuka- Japanese manga artist, cartoonist, animator, film producer and activist. He is best known as the creator of the comics series “Astro Boy”,“Kimba the White Lion”, “Black Jack” and “Phoenix”. Known as "The Father of Manga", "The Godfather of Manga" and "The God of Manga". The distinctive"large eyes" style of Japanese animation was invented by Tezuka, drawing inspiration from Western cartoons and animated films of the time such as “Betty Boop”, “Mickey Mouse” and other Disney movies.

Part B

Short Essay Questions

Answer any 6 out of 8 questions Each question carries 5 marks

8. The first multiplane camera was invented by former Walt Disney Studio animator/director Ub Iwerks in 1933. The multiplane camera is a special motion picture camera used in the traditional animation process that moves a number of pieces of artwork past the camera at various speeds and at various distances from one another. This creates a three-dimensional effect.



9. Motion Capture- is the process of recording the movement of objects or people and using that information to animate digital character models in 2D or 3D computer animation. “Sinbad: Beyond The Veil of Mists” is the first feature length computer animation film created by Pentamedia, India using motion-capture. Avatar- Na’vi character was done using this technique.
10. Traditional animation is also known as Classical animation, Hand-drawn animation or Cel animation.Process- Concept/ Idea- Storyboard- Character Design- Drawing- Ink – Background- Photography
11. Felix the Cat was created by Otto Messmer and Pat Sullivan. Felix was the first cartoon character created and developed for the screen. Pat Sullivan took the credit for Felix, even though Otto Messmer directed and was the lead animator on all of the episodes he appeared in. “Felix the Cat” starred in over 150 cartoons until 1931. The newspaper strip’s popularity began to fade in the late 1930s, though the character was reintroduced to new fans via comic books in the 1940s. Felix’s design was simple yet expressive. His round eyes, wide grin and anthropomorphic features made him highly relatable and engaging for audiences. His fluid, exaggerated movements helped him convey emotions and actions without the need for dialogue. Felix was portrayed as mischievous, resourceful and full of personality.
12. Capturing Live action movement- Rotoscope- Animating- Finalizing the animation
13. Matte painting is a technique that involves creating detailed, hand-painted artwork on a transparent surface, which is then combined with live-action footage to enhance or extend the visual environment of a film. Matte paintings were often used to create expansive landscapes, cityscapes or fantasy worlds that would have been too costly or impossible to build physically.Challenges faced by the artist was lighting, perspective, shadow.
14. Ram Mohan - Father of Indian Animation, started his career at cartoon films unit, Films Division of India. Ram Mohan was responsible for the spread of animation in India. Prominent work- "Ek Anek Aur Ekta"- The film conveyed the message of unity in diversity and was frequently broadcasted on Doordarshan. Mohan’s contributions continue to be seen in the legacy of Indian animation studios and the global success of films like *Baahubali* and *Chhota Bheem*.
15. Director George Lucas and visual effects supervisor John Dykstra, along with the team at ILM, utilized miniatures in groundbreaking ways to create the iconic space battles in *Star Wars*. In *Star Wars*, many of the iconic spacecraft, such as the

Millennium Falcon**,** X-Wing fighters, were created as highly detailed miniatures.The filmmakers used miniatures in combination with motion control cameras to capture smooth and dynamic movements. The miniatures were mounted on rigs and moved in controlled ways allowing them to fly through space with realistic motion and speed. The miniatures were combined with live-action footage using compositing techniques, such as optical printing. The biggest innovations in *Star Wars* was the development of motion control cameras which allowed for the smooth, repeatable motion of miniatures during filming. The motion control system enabled multiple miniatures to be filmed in one shot with perfect synchronization between the moving spacecraft.

Part C

Essay Type Questions

Answer any 2 questions Each question carries 15 marks

16. Early days – Origin of animation- devices- silent era- animation pioneers- golden age of animation- technological development (Rotoscope, Mo-cap,etc)- AI
17. Edward Muybridge an English photographer worked in photographic studies of motion. Known for his studies in animal locomotion. Muybridge's experiment.
18. Answer based on individuals point of view.